

Instructor: Date:

Learner: Regional Branch:

Program: Center:

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Let's Start!

That's why they call it the blues!



Learning Outcome

Describe situations in spoken interactions according to work and social contexts.

Can Do Statements

- I can talk about music, and being famous.
- I can talk hypothetically about the past.
- I can speculate about the past.

Ask your partner:

- What do you know about the origin of rock and roll?
- What type of music do you prefer to listen to? Why?





Let's Explore!

Rock and roll has its roots in rhythm and blues.



Instructions: Read the text aloud.

You must have heard the names Chuck Berry, Elvis Presley, and the Beatles before! Did you realize that they had something in common? If you had answered that they are four of the greatest rock and roll acts ever, then you would have been right. If it hadn't been for these artists, and the music they created, music wouldn't have been the same.

If there hadn't been any African-American rhythm and blues artists, rock and roll would never have been born. In the early 1950s, singers like Chuck Berry and "Fats" Domino got radio attention. We've listened to singers and songwriters who've been influenced by them ever since.

American teenagers were drawn to the driving dance rhythms, lyrics, and its messages. Teens could have just been happy that their parents disapproved at first. They might have enjoyed playing music the older generation hated. Whatever the reason, it caught on and it has held on. If it hadn't, we could have been listening to Bach!

Music producers quickly marketed the new musical style. You might have known that Elvis quickly became rock and roll's first superstar. He became the king of rock and roll almost overnight. Even today, almost 50 years after his death, he has still got that title in his grasp.

You may not know that the British beat swept into North America in the 60's. It changed the industry once again. Music for the young has changed many times since then. If your generation hadn't had their own music, what could they have listened to?



Let's Practice!

What do you know about the past?

Instructions: Read and circle the correct words to complete the sentences. Read the sentences aloud. Check your pronunciation with your instructor.

1. You **must have heard** / **must had heard** / **must hear** the names Chuck Berry, Elvis Presley, and the Beatles before!
2. Teens **could had** / **could** / **could have** just been happy that their parents disapproved at first.
3. They **might** / **might have enjoyed** / **have might** playing music the older generation hated.
4. You **might have known** / **might known** / **might had** that Elvis quickly became rock and roll's first superstar.
5. You **may not know** / **may not known** / **may known** that the British beat swept into North America in the 60's.



Let's Practice!

What if ...

Instructions: Choose the words from the Word Bank to correctly complete the sentences. Read the sentences aloud. Check your pronunciation with your instructor.

Word Bank

- could
- had answered
- music wouldn't have
- would never have
- could have been listening

1. If you _____ that they are four of the greatest rock and roll acts ever, then you would have been right.
2. If it hadn't been for these artists, and the music they created, _____ been the same.
3. If there hadn't been any African-American rhythm and blues artists, rock and roll _____ been born.
4. If it hadn't, we _____ to Bach!
5. If your generation hadn't had their own music, what _____ they have listened to?





Extension Activity

Listen to an early rock and roll song.

Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.

- Go online or to the library and find a song and lyrics sung by Chuck Berry or Elvis Presley.
- Listen to the song without looking at the lyrics, and see how much you can write down by listening to it 3 or 4 times.
- Now take the lyrics and compare it to what you have written.
- Highlight mistakes, note words that you have left out, and correct them.
- Listen again with the complete lyrics sheet.
- Take your song to class and read the lyrics to a partner.
- Discuss what you think the song is about and anything that might be unclear.

Self-Assessment

Yes No

I listen to a song sung by Chuck Berry or Elvis Presley.

☐ ☐

I write down the lyrics as I listen.

☐ ☐

I compare what I have written to the lyrics sheet.

☐ ☐

I make corrections and note words I have missed.

☐ ☐

I take my lyrics to class and share them with a partner.

☐ ☐

I discuss the meaning of the song and any unclear ideas in it with a partner.

☐ ☐


Target Words

- blues** (noun): a musical style originating in the southern United States by African American musicians, characterized by strong rhythms and sad lyrics
e.g. If there hadn't been any African-American rhythm and blues artists, rock and roll would never have been born.
- to disapprove** (verb): to feel that something or someone is bad, wrong, etc.
e.g. Teens could have just been happy that their parents disapproved at first.
- grasp** (noun): Grip
e.g. Even today, almost 50 years after his death, he has still got that title in his grasp.
- to sweep (into)** (verb): to enter a physical space or a field of activity in a way that makes a strong impression
e.g. You may not know that the British beat swept into North America in the 60's.
- driving** (adjective): strong and powerful; having a strong influence in making something happen
e.g. American teenagers were drawn to the driving dance rhythms, lyrics, and its messages.
- to influence** (verb): to have an effect on the way that somebody behaves or thinks, especially by giving them an example to follow
e.g. We've listened to singers and songwriters who've been influenced by them ever since.
- rock and roll** (noun): a style of popular dance music that began in the 1950s in the US and has a strong, loud beat and simple repeated tunes
e.g. If there hadn't been any African-American rhythm and blues artists, rock and roll would never have been born.



Learning Points

Talking Hypothetically about the Past

You use **could have** and **would have** to talk about things that were possible in the past and may or may not have happened.

You often use these structures with the third conditional.

The structure:

Subject	modal	have	past participle
I	could	have	done
She	would	have	said

You use **could have** to talk about alternatives for actions that were completed in the past. For example: *If it hadn't, we **could have been** listening to Bach!*

You use **would have** to speculate on how the present be different if different choices were made in the past.

For example: *If you had answered that they are four of the greatest rock and roll acts ever, then you **would have been** right.*

Look at the chart below for the structure of the third conditional:

Conditional Name	Structure	Example
Third	If + Past Perfect, <i>could/would have</i> + past participle	<i>If</i> your generation <i>hadn't had</i> their own music, what <i>could they have listened</i> to?

Examples:

- *If you had answered that they are four of the greatest rock and roll acts ever, then you would have been right.*
- *If it hadn't been for these artists, and the music they created, music wouldn't have been the same.*
- *If it hadn't, we could have been listening to Bach!*



Learning Points

Speculation About the Past

You can use **modals** to talk about degrees of certainty and speculate about things in the past.

You use them to describe what is definite, probable, possible, or impossible from the speaker's point of view.

You can use **must**, **may**, **might**, and **could** to describe degrees of certainty.

You can use modals with the **Present Perfect** to talk about the possibility of a past event that is not clear in the present context.

Example:

You **must have heard** the names Chuck Berry, Elvis Presley, and the Beatles before!

Look at the chart for the meanings of modals when speculating about the past:

Modal Phrase	Meaning
Must have	It is very likely
May have Might have Could have	It is possible

- *May have has a slightly stronger meaning than might have or could have.*
- *You can add **not** to make a negative speculation (It **may not have been** true).*

Examples:

- *You may not know that the British beat swept into North America in the 60's.*
- *You might have known that Elvis quickly became rock and roll's first superstar.*
- *Teens could have just been happy that their parents disapproved at first.*
- *They might have enjoyed playing music the older generation hated.*

